

[Credit.com](#) said if you're denied, the denier is legally required to send you a letter explaining why, which is obviously a super fun thing to get in the mail. Credit itself shows up on your credit report only six months after you start accruing it, so it may take time to build.

It won't surprise you to learn that The Points Guy is a die-hard credit card fan who believes people should not be using cash. He says cash is too easy to lose or have stolen. With cash, you won't get fraud or other protections, and you're not earning anything back. (I'm not sure my paranoid self agrees with this. I think you should have a mix of both.) He also thinks it's easier to track your finances with credit cards for budgeting and tax purposes. This is directly opposed to bipolar activist Julie Fast who needs cash to feel aware of what she's spent or my friends, like sex workers or undocumented people, who have to operate in a cash economy because of their jobs, circumstances, or lifestyles. Don't feel badly if you're more like Fast and my friends than you are like The Points Guy. Or maybe you're like me, falling somewhere in between.



TAKEAWAYS

- ° Credit cards CAN be dangerous if you use them to spend more than you can afford—especially due to high interest rates. (Know your interest rates!) Ideally you should use them just the way you would use cash (not spending more than you could reasonably pay back at some point) and paying them off on time.
- ° If you are a responsible credit card holder, you can have access to some really great perks like cash back, price rewind (a deal where if you find the thing you bought at a cheaper price, Citibank will refund you the difference), and travel insurance in case you lose your bags or your stuff is